

MSP | MSP-08

Programme Plan

Integrated schedule of projects, tranches and business change

Meridian Group

Programme Helios — Infrastructure and Platform Stack for AI GPU Compute at Scale

Field	Detail
Document title	Programme Plan
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Date	18 Sep 2026
Author	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Owner	Programme Manager
Approver	Programme Board
Classification	Internal
Retention	7 years from programme closure

Document control

Version history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
0.1	04 Jun 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Initial draft
0.2	21 Jul 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Updated following workstream lead review
1.0	18 Sep 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate

Reviewers

Name	Role	Review scope	Date reviewed
T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	Chief Platform Architect	Technical content and solution alignment	08 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Security, assurance and residency content	10 Sep 2026
C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	Finance Business Partner	Cost, funding and benefit figures	11 Sep 2026
M. Verity, Head of P3O	Head of P3O	Governance standards and completeness	15 Sep 2026

Approval

This product is baselined once approval is recorded below. Any subsequent change must go through change control.

Name	Role	Decision	Date
R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Senior Responsible Owner / Group CTO	Approved	18 Sep 2026
H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	Director of Infrastructure	Approved	18 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Approved subject to closure of ISS-003	18 Sep 2026

Related products

Reference	Product	Relationship
MSP-10	Projects Dossier	Component projects
MSP-07	Benefits Realisation Plan	Aligned to tranches
MSP-12	Programme Dependency Register	Detailed dependencies

How to use this template

Aspect	Guidance
Purpose	Brings together project schedules, business change activity, benefit realisation and resource requirements into a single view of the programme over time.
Framework	MSP — Structure theme; created in Define the Programme
Created when	Define the Programme
Reviewed / updated	Continuously; formally at each tranche boundary
Owner	Programme Manager
Approver	Programme Board
Format options	Document, presentation, register entry, or tool record — the content matters, not the medium.
Tailoring	Scale the depth of each section to the scale, risk and complexity of the work. Delete sections that add no value and record the tailoring decision in the governance approach.

This is a worked example. Every field has been completed with illustrative content for Programme Helios, a fictional AI GPU infrastructure and platform programme. All example content is shown in grey italic — the black text is the template itself. Replace the grey italic content with your own.

Quality criteria

Use these to check the product is fit for purpose before submitting it for approval.

- Tranches are defined by capability delivery, not by calendar convenience
- Dependencies between projects and to external parties are explicit and owned
- Business change activity appears alongside project delivery, not after it
- Resource demand is aggregated across projects and reconciled with supply

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1. Plan overview and assumptions

Meridian Group operates fragmented AI compute across four departmental estates with an average GPU utilisation of 31% and annual public cloud GPU rental of AED 19.4m. Demand from AI Research, Fraud Analytics and the Retail division is growing faster than any single department can fund. Programme Helios consolidates that demand onto a single shared platform in DXB-1, scaling from a 256-GPU pilot to 4,096 GPUs across three tranches, with liquid cooling, a 400G RoCEv2 fabric, a multi-tenant orchestration platform and an MLOps stack.

2. Tranche structure

Tranche	Name	Start	End	Capability delivered	End-of-tranche review
Tranche 1	Tranche 1	23 Apr 2027	31 Mar 2027	Partially	Tranche 1
Tranche 2	Tranche 2	31 Mar 2027	26 Feb 2027	Yes	Tranche 2
Tranche 3	Tranche 3	26 Feb 2027	31 Jan 2027	No	Tranche 3

3. Programme schedule

Insert the integrated Gantt or roadmap showing projects, tranches, business change and benefit realisation on one timeline.

Programme Helios — Tranche 2 scale build, DXB-1 halls A and B. Verified at hall A acceptance on 26 Feb 2027. Detail is maintained by the Programme Manager and reviewed at the monthly Programme Board.

4. Project schedule summary

Project ID	Project	Tranche	Start	End	Key outputs	Status
PJ-01	Facilities and power uplift	Tranche 2	01 Sep 2026	30 Jun 2027	Energised supply, CDUs and secondary loop, strengthened floors	In progress
PJ-02	Compute and storage build	Tranche 2	15 Oct 2026	25 Jun 2027	Hall A and B accepted; storage accepted at 1.2 TB/s	In progress
PJ-03	Network fabric	Tranche 2	01 Sep 2026	31 Mar 2027	Fabric commissioned and NCCL-validated	In progress
PJ-04	Platform and orchestration	Tranche 2	01 Oct 2026	31 Mar 2027	Platform v1.0 released	In progress
PJ-05	MLOps and developer experience	Tranche 2	01 Nov 2026	30 Jun 2027	Self-service portal, lineage capture	Not started
PJ-06	Security and compliance	Tranche 2	01 Sep 2026	31 Jul 2027	Assurance report with findings closed	In progress
PJ-07	Service operations	Tranche	01 Feb	30 Jul	Service transition	Not

Project ID	Project	Tranche	Start	End	Key outputs	Status
	readiness	2	2027	2027	complete	started
PJ-08	Adoption and business change	Tranche 2	01 Sep 2026	31 Aug 2027	Three tenants onboarded; 80% of researchers trained	In progress

5. Programme milestones

Ref	Milestone	Type	Baseline date	Forecast date	Owner
MS-01	Programme mandate approved and funding released for Tranche 1	Gate	12 Mar 2026	12 Mar 2026	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO
MS-02	Pilot cluster of 256 GPUs live in DXB-1 hall A	Delivery	28 Aug 2026	28 Aug 2026	S. Bhatt, Project Manager
MS-03	Tranche 1 end-of-tranche review and Tranche 2 funding gate	Gate	18 Sep 2026	18 Sep 2026	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO
MS-04	Hall B structural strengthening complete	Delivery	15 Dec 2026	15 Dec 2026	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead
MS-05	Utility uplift to 6 MVA energised	External	30 Nov 2026	30 Nov 2026	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead
MS-06	Hall A scaled to 1,024 GPUs and accepted	Delivery	26 Feb 2027	26 Feb 2027	S. Bhatt, Project Manager
MS-07	Platform v1.0 released — scheduling, quota, observability, image supply chain	Delivery	31 Mar 2027	31 Mar 2027	P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead
MS-08	Independent security assurance and penetration test passed	Assurance	23 Apr 2027	23 Apr 2027	L. Haddad, CISO

6. Business change and transition activities

Ref	Activity	Tranche	Start	End	Owner
A-010	Complete hall B structural survey	Tranche 3	26 Feb 2027	31 Mar 2027	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead
A-020	Place structural strengthening order	Tranche 1	31 Mar 2027	23 Apr 2027	E. Santos, Procurement Lead
A-030	Execute floor strengthening works	Tranche 2	23 Apr 2027	28 May 2027	A. Kowalski, Data

Ref	Activity	Tranche	Start	End	Owner
					Centre Lead
A-040	Lodge utility uplift application	Tranche 3	28 May 2027	25 Jun 2027	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead
A-050	Install switchgear and energise 6 MVA supply	Tranche 1	25 Jun 2027	18 Sep 2026	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead
A-060	Install CDUs and secondary cooling loop	Tranche 2	18 Sep 2026	15 Oct 2026	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead

7. Critical path and float

The critical path through the programme, and where float exists that could absorb delay.

Programme Helios — Tranche 2 scale build, DXB-1 halls A and B. Applies from hall A handover; hall B follows in Tranche 2 closure. Detail is maintained by the Programme Manager and reviewed at the monthly Programme Board.

8. Resource requirements

Resource / capability	Tranche 1	Tranche 2	Tranche 3	Total	Source
Platform engineer (SRE)	1.7 FTE	4.5 FTE	11.6 FTE	10.2 FTE	Recruitment, with contractor bridge
Network engineer — fabric	6.9 FTE	3.3 FTE	7.3 FTE	6.8 FTE	Internal from the network team
Data centre engineer	4.6 FTE	2.0 FTE	5.1 FTE	27.2 FTE	Internal plus M&E contractor
Security architect	3.4 FTE	7.8 FTE	3.6 FTE	17.0 FTE	Internal from Group Security
ML platform engineer	2.3 FTE	5.2 FTE	2.2 FTE	11.9 FTE	Internal conversion from data engineering
Storage engineer	2.3 FTE	6.5 FTE	3.6 FTE	20.4 FTE	Vendor professional services
Business change lead	3.4 FTE	10.4 FTE	5.1 FTE	5.1 FTE	Internal from Group Change

9. Programme costs by tranche

Cost category	Tranche 1	Tranche 2	Tranche 3	Total
Project delivery	AED 980,000	AED 1,960,000	AED 2,940,000	AED 91,200,000
Business change	AED 623,000	AED 1,246,000	AED 1,869,000	AED 17,800,000
Programme management	AED 623,000	AED 1,246,000	AED 1,869,000	AED 13,600,000

Cost category	Tranche 1	Tranche 2	Tranche 3	Total
Assurance	AED 434,000	AED 868,000	AED 1,302,000	AED 24,300,000
Contingency	AED 623,000	AED 1,246,000	AED 1,869,000	AED 6,800,000
Total	AED 1,610,000	AED 3,220,000	AED 4,830,000	AED 11,200,000

10. Programme tolerances

Dimension	Programme tolerance	Tranche tolerance	Escalate to
Time	<i>Programme Helios</i>	10 working days	90 days
Cost	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation
Scope	Defined by the Tranche 2 scope statement; changed only by approved change request	In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.	In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.
Quality	No open critical or high security findings; acceptance benchmarks met in full	No open critical or high security findings; acceptance benchmarks met in full	No open critical or high security findings; acceptance benchmarks met in full
Risk	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance
Benefit	No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation	No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation	No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation

11. Scheduling constraints

Constraint	Detail	Source	Impact on plan
Vendor GPU allocation of 2,048 units for Tranche 2 will be honoured at the quoted delivery dates	Applies to all workloads on the DXB-1 estate without exception	Vendor allocation letter, Jun 2026	Tranche 2 completion slips by at least one quarter and contract terms are renegotiated
DXB-1 has 6 MVA of usable capacity available to the programme without a utility upgrade	Delegated to the Programme Manager within tolerance; above tolerance to the Programme Board	Site capacity study, May 2026	Tranche 2 capped at 1,024 GPUs and the AUH-2 site is brought forward two quarters
Three business units will migrate committed workloads within six months of hall A handover	Reviewed at each end-of-tranche review and updated by change control only	Business case, Apr 2026	Utilisation benefit of AED 14.2m over five years is not realised in full
Training data classified as Restricted must remain within UAE borders at rest and in transit	Enforced automatically in the pipeline; manual assertion is not accepted as evidence	Group data residency policy v4.2	Not applicable — this is a fixed constraint on design
Liquid cooling maintenance can be absorbed by the existing facilities contract without an uplift	Any deviation requires a recorded waiver accepted by the CISO with a stated expiry	FM contract review, Jun 2026	Annual run cost increases by approximately AED 780,000